MASTERFUNCTIONALSKILLS

★ OFQUAL REGULATED STANDARDS

DIGITAL FUNCTIONAL SKILLS (DFSQ) | Digital DFSQ Standard

Digital Functional Skills Revision Cards

Spreadsheet Formulas • Online Security • Devices

- ★ Essential Excel/Sheets Formulas (=SUM, =AVERAGE)
- ★ File Extensions (.pdf, .docx, .xlsx, .csv)
- ★ Strong Passwords & Two-Factor Authentication
- ★ Phishing Detection & GDPR Privacy Rules

A6 Postcard Cardstock (148 × 105 mm)

Turn over for Deck Contents & Checklist ➔

📋 DECK CONTENTS & REVISION CHECKLIST

50 Revision Cards

Tick [✓] Read when you understand the rule, and [★] Solved when you answer the challenge!

Pearson & C&G Aligned

1. OS Settings & Accessibility (DFS 1.1)
2. File Management & Naming (DFS 1.2)
3. File Extensions & Formats (DFS 1.3)
4. Cloud Storage & Syncing (DFS 1.4)
5. Search Engine Operators (DFS 1.5)
6. Evaluating Online Information (DFS 1.6)
7. Device Storage vs RAM (DFS 1.7)
8. Compressing & Extracting (.zip) (DFS 1.8)
9. Basic Troubleshooting (DFS 1.9)
10. Data Protection & UK GDPR (DFS 1.10)
11. Word Processing: Headings & Styles (DFS 2.1)
12. Word Processing: Tables & Lists (DFS 2.2)
13. Images & Text Wrapping (DFS 2.3)
14. Spreadsheets: Anatomy of a Sheet (DFS 2.4)
15. Spreadsheets: Basic Arithmetic (DFS 2.5)
16. Spreadsheets: SUM & AVERAGE (DFS 2.6)
17. Spreadsheets: COUNT vs COUNTA (DFS 2.7)
18. Spreadsheets: Simple IF Statements (DFS 2.8)
19. Spreadsheets: Sorting & Filtering (DFS 2.9)
20. Spreadsheets: Creating Charts (DFS 2.10)
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25. Professional Email Structure (DFS 3.1)
26. Email Fields: To, Cc & Bcc (DFS 3.2)
27. Email Attachments & Cloud Links (DFS 3.3)
28. Video Calling Setup & Etiquette (DFS 3.4)
29. Workplace Messaging (Teams/Slack) (DFS 3.5)
30. Online Calendar Invites & Scheduling (DFS 3.6)
31. Digital Netiquette & Tone (DFS 3.7)
32. Document Sharing Permissions (DFS 3.8)
33. Secure Online Purchasing & HTTPS (DFS 4.1)
34. Payment Methods & Section 75 (DFS 4.2)
35. Online Banking & Statements (DFS 4.3)
36. Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) (DFS 4.4)
37. Accessing Public Services Online (DFS 4.5)
38. Online Consumer Rights & Returns (DFS 4.6)
39. Digital Receipts & Order Tracking (DFS 4.7)
40. Subscriptions & Auto-Renewals (DFS 4.8)
41. Strong Passwords & Passphrases (DFS 5.1)
42. Password Managers & Safe Storage (DFS 5.2)
43. Spotting Phishing & Smishing (DFS 5.3)
44. Malware, Viruses & Ransomware (DFS 5.4)
45. Software Updates & Security Patches (DFS 5.5)
46. Public Wi-Fi Risks & VPNs (DFS 5.6)
47. Social Media Privacy Settings (DFS 5.7)
48. Digital Footprint & Reputation (DFS 5.8)
49. Digital Wellbeing & Ergonomics (DFS 5.9)
50. Copyright & Creative Commons (DFS 5.10)

💡 **Tutor Golden Tip (Abdul):** Do not flip the card immediately! Attempt the Quick Challenge on the back using a dry-wipe pen or scratchpad first. Verify with the step-by-step model steps only after completing your working.

Tailoring Your Device

Accessibility settings assist users with physical or cognitive impairments: High Contrast Mode (visual clarity), Text Scaling / Magnifier (enlarging text), Screen Reader (Narrator), Sticky Keys (motor support).

ACCESSIBILITY SETTINGS

- **High Contrast & Dark Mode (Low vision)**
- **Screen Magnifier / Zoom (Large font scaling)**
- **Screen Reader / Text-to-Speech (Dyslexia & blind)**

★ **Golden Rule: Accessibility features ensure digital inclusion for all users!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't confuse display brightness with high-contrast accessibility themes.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DFS 1.1

Which accessibility feature allows a user with visual impairment to hear text read aloud from the screen?

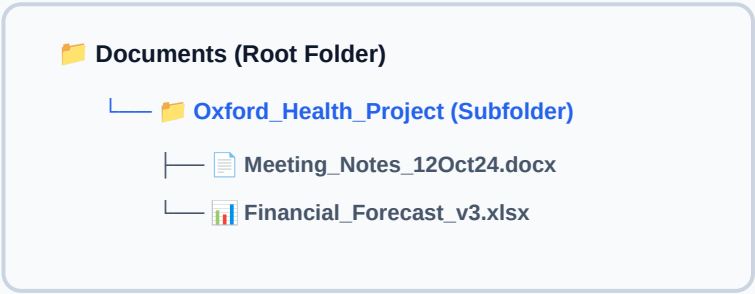
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

A screen reader (or text-to-speech / Narrator).

Hierarchical Folders & Version Control

Organise files into logical tree hierarchies: Root Folder → Subfolder → Specific file. Meaningful naming convention: Topic_Project_Date_Version (e.g. Budget_Q3_2024_v2.xlsx). Avoid 'Doc1.docx'.



★ **Golden Rule: Include the date (YYYY-MM-DD) and version number (v1, v2) in filename!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Avoid saving everything to your Desktop — it causes system clutter and data loss risk.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 1.2

Suggest a professional filename for the second draft of a staff training plan written in October 2024.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Staff_Training_Plan_Oct2024_v2.docx.

Recognising Common File Types

.docx = Word processing. .pdf = Portable read-only document (universal). .xlsx / .csv = Spreadsheets / raw comma-separated data. .pptx = Slideshow. .png / .jpg = Images. .mp4 = Video. .zip = Compressed folder.

FILE FORMAT QUICK REFERENCE

- **.docx: Editable text document (Word)**
- **.pdf: Fixed layout, non-editable reader format**
- **.xlsx / .csv: Financial spreadsheets & data tables**

★ **Golden Rule: Export to PDF before sharing to keep layout and formatting intact!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: A .csv file saves raw data only — all formulas and styling are lost.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 1.3

Which file format should you choose to ensure a formal report cannot be accidentally altered by the recipient?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER

FULL MARKS

PDF (.pdf - Portable Document Format).

Remote Servers & Multi-Device Access

Cloud storage (OneDrive, Google Drive, iCloud) stores files on secure remote servers over the Internet. Benefits: Automatic backup, access from any device, easy real-time collaboration. Requires internet connectivity.

CLOUD STORAGE ADVANTAGES

- ✓ Access files from phone, tablet, and PC
- ✓ Automatic real-time off-site backup
- ✓ Multiple people can edit simultaneously

★ **Golden Rule: Cloud files protect you against hardware crashes, fires, or stolen laptops!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: If you don't enable 'Keep on this device' (offline mode), you cannot open cloud files without Wi-Fi.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DFS 1.4

State two benefits of saving business documents to cloud storage rather than a local USB flash drive.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

1. Files are backed up remotely if the physical device is lost/damaged. 2. Documents can be accessed from any location or device with internet.

Boolean & Precision Search Tricks

Quotation Marks ("..."): Searches for the EXACT phrase in that precise order. Minus Sign (-word): Excludes unwanted results. site:gov.uk: Restricts search to official government websites.

ADVANCED SEARCH OPERATORS

"functional skills maths" → Exact phrase only

jaguar speed -car → Excludes automobile results

site:gov.uk apprenticeship → Official sites only

★ Golden Rule: Use quotation marks to search for exact multi-word terms!

⚠️ Watch Out: Don't put a space after the minus sign (type '-car', NOT '- car').

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DFS 1.5

What search query would you type to find exact information on NHS dental fees while excluding private dentists?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

"NHS dental fees" -private (or site:nhs.uk "dental fees").

Domains & Sponsored Ads

Top-level domains: .gov.uk = Official UK government. .ac.uk = Universities. .org = Non-profit organisations. .com / .co.uk = Commercial businesses. Look out for 'Sponsored / Ad' tags at top of search results.

CHECKING WEBSITE RELIABILITY

.gov.uk & .nhs.uk: Highly authoritative

.ac.uk: Academic university research

Sponsored / Ad tags: Commercial promotion

★ **Golden Rule: Cross-check web information across at least two trusted sources!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Watch for lookalike URLs and typosquatting domains (e.g. paypa1.com).**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 1.6

Why is information found on a .gov.uk website generally more reliable than a .com website for renewing a passport?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

.gov.uk is the official UK government portal, whereas .com sites are commercial agencies that often charge extra fees.

Storage (SSD/Hard Drive) vs RAM

Storage (GB/TB): Permanent memory holding files and apps when PC is turned off. RAM (Random Access Memory): Temporary working memory used while apps are open. Free up storage by deleting temp files and emptying Recycle Bin.

STORAGE (SSD/HDD)

- Permanent file storage
- 256 GB / 1 TB
- Survives restarts

MEMORY (RAM)

- Active app workspace
- 8 GB / 16 GB
- Clears on restart

★ **Golden Rule: Empty your Recycle Bin / Trash to permanently reclaim disk storage!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Running out of RAM makes your computer freeze; running out of Storage prevents saving new files.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 1.7

State two actions you can take if your smartphone displays a 'Storage Full' warning.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

1. Delete unused apps or clear app caches. 2. Back up photos/videos to cloud storage or delete large video files.

Reducing File Size for Email

Compress (Zip): Shrinks file size and bundles multiple documents into one single .zip folder for emailing. Extract: Unpacks the zipped files into normal editable documents.

ZIPPING & EXTRACTING FILES

Compress: Right-click → 'Send to compressed folder'

Combines 10 files into 1 small .zip attachment

Extract: Right-click .zip → 'Extract All...' to view

★ **Golden Rule: You must EXTRACT files before you can properly edit and save them!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: If you edit files directly inside an unextracted zip, changes may be lost.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 1.8

Why is it beneficial to zip five large image files before sending them by email?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Zipping reduces the overall file size to fit within email attachment limits and bundles all images into one file.

First Steps When Tech Fails

App frozen: Open Task Manager (Ctrl + Shift + Esc) and select 'End Task'. Wi-Fi dropped: Check flight mode, restart router, toggle Wi-Fi off and on. Total system freeze: Hold power button for 10 seconds to reboot.

FIRST RESPONSE TROUBLESHOOTING

1. App Frozen? Press Ctrl+Shift+Esc → 'End Task'
2. No Internet? Check Airplane mode & restart Wi-Fi router
3. The Golden Rule: Restart the computer before calling IT!

★ Golden Rule: Restarting clears memory caches — try it first before calling support!

⚠️ Watch Out: Never unplug a PC while it is writing data or installing updates.

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DFS 1.9

What keyboard shortcut opens Windows Task Manager directly to close a frozen program?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

Ctrl + Shift + Esc (or Ctrl + Alt + Delete).

Handling Personal Data Lawfully

Personal data relates to an identifiable living person (names, NHS numbers, addresses). Under UK GDPR: 1. Process lawfully, fairly, and transparently. 2. Keep accurate and secure. 3. Delete when no longer required.

UK GDPR KEY PRINCIPLES

- **Collect only the data that is strictly necessary**
- **Keep data secure with encryption & passwords**
- **Never share patient/client records without consent**

★ **Golden Rule: Always lock your computer screen (Win + L) when leaving your desk!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Leaving customer spreadsheets visible on an unattended screen is a serious GDPR data breach.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 1.10

State two ways you can protect sensitive customer data on a workplace laptop.

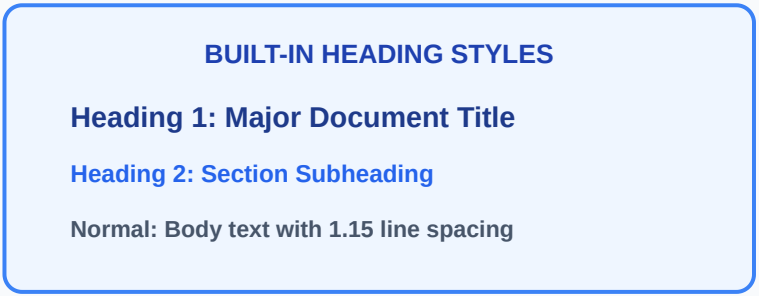
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

1. Use strong password protection / encryption. 2. Lock your screen whenever stepping away from the device.

H1, H2 & Consistent Hierarchy

Use built-in Heading Styles (Heading 1 for main titles, Heading 2 for subheadings) instead of manually bolding and enlarging text. This creates an automatic table of contents and screen-reader structure.



★ **Golden Rule: Use Heading styles to automatically create clickable Contents pages!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Use Ctrl + Enter for new pages — never press Enter multiple times.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 2.1

What keyboard shortcut inserts a new page break instantly in Microsoft Word or Google Docs?

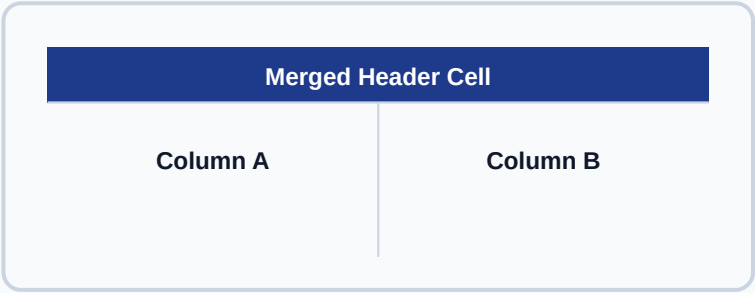
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Ctrl + Enter.

Organising Information into Columns

Tables: Insert rows and columns to align comparative data neatly. Merge cells to create spanning banner headers. Set header rows to repeat across page breaks.



★ **Golden Rule: Use tables to align numbers and facts rather than pressing the Spacebar or Tab key!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Never align text by tapping the spacebar repeatedly — it falls out of alignment on other screens.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DFS 2.2

What table feature combines two or more adjacent cells into a single large cell?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

Merge Cells.

Square, Tight & Aspect Ratio

Always resize images using CORNER handles to maintain original aspect ratio (prevent squishing). Text Wrapping: 'Square' or 'Tight' wraps text smoothly around the picture. Always add Alt Text for accessibility.



★ **Golden Rule: Drag corner handles only so images keep their proper proportions!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Always add Alt Text to images for accessibility and screen readers.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 2.3

Why should you provide Alt Text (alternative text) when inserting an image into a document or website?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Alt Text allows screen readers to describe the image to visually impaired users.

Columns, Rows & Cell References

Columns: Lettered vertically (A, B, C...). Rows: Numbered horizontally (1, 2, 3...). Cell Reference: The intersection letter + number (e.g. B4 = column B, row 4). Format cells as Currency (£), Percentage (%), or Date.



★ Golden Rule: Column Letter ALWAYS comes before the Row Number (e.g. C5, NEVER 5C)!

⚠️ Watch Out: Format raw numbers as Currency (£) so the pound sign appears automatically.

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 2.4

What cell reference is located at the intersection of column D and row 14?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

D14.

Always Start with an Equals Sign (=)

Every formula in Excel / Google Sheets MUST begin with '=': Add: =A1+B1. Subtract: =A1-B1. Multiply: =A1*B1 (asterisk). Divide: =A1/B1 (forward slash). Never type hardcoded numbers into formulas.

SPREADSHEET OPERATORS

Addition: =B2 + C2

Subtraction: =B2 - C2

Multiplication: =B2 * C2 (Asterisk *)

Division: =B2 / C2 (Slash /)

★ **Golden Rule: Always begin spreadsheet formulas with '=' (e.g. =A1+B1)!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Use '*' to multiply and '/' to divide — never type the letter 'x'.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 2.5

Write the formula to multiply the quantity in cell B4 by the unit price in cell C4.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

=B4*C4.

Ranges with Colons (e.g. B2:B10)

=SUM(B2:B10): Adds all numbers in range. =AVERAGE(B2:B10): Calculates mean. =MAX(B2:B10): Finds highest value. =MIN(B2:B10): Finds lowest value. Colon (:) means 'through to'.

CORE EXCEL FUNCTIONS

- **=SUM(C2:C20) → Total of all 19 cells**
- **=AVERAGE(C2:C20) → Mean average score**
- **=MAX(C2:C20) • =MIN(C2:C20)**

★ **Golden Rule: The colon (:) indicates a contiguous cell range from start to finish!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't write '=SUM(A1+A2)' — either write '=SUM(A1:A2)' or '=A1+A2'.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 2.6

Write the function to calculate the average of sales in cells D3 to D15.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER

FULL MARKS

=AVERAGE(D3:D15).

Count Numbers vs Count Non-Empty Cells

=COUNT(range): Counts ONLY cells containing NUMBERS. =COUNTA(range): Counts ALL non-empty cells (numbers, text, symbols). Think 'Count All' (COUNTA).

=COUNT(A1:A10)

Counts NUMBERS only

Ignores names and text

Numerical tallies

=COUNTA(A1:A10)

Counts ALL non-empty

Counts names, codes & text

Attendee rosters

★ **Golden Rule: Use COUNTA to count attendee names or text entries!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: If you use COUNT on a column of patient names, the answer will be 0!**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 2.7

Which function should you use to count how many employees signed in on a text attendance sheet in cells B2 to B30?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

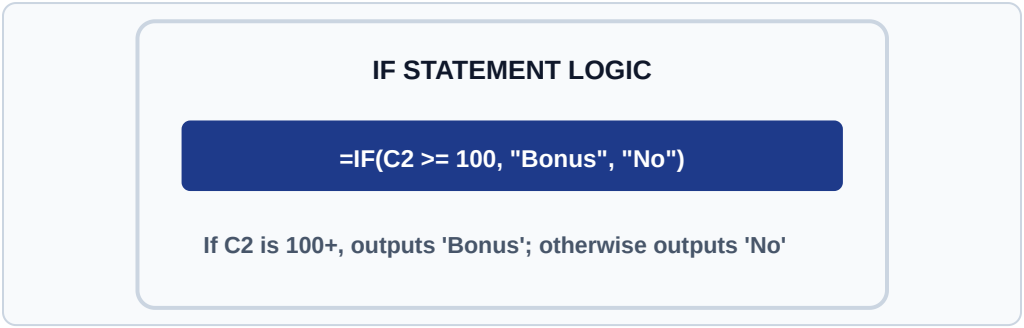
✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER

FULL MARKS

=COUNTA(B2:B30).

=IF(condition, value_if_true, value_if_false)

Syntax: 1. Test condition (e.g. B2>=50). 2. Value if TRUE in quotes ("Pass"). 3. Value if FALSE in quotes ("Fail"). Example: =IF(B2>=50, "Pass", "Fail").



★ **Golden Rule: Text outputs in IF statements MUST be enclosed in quotation marks ("...")!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't forget the commas separating the three arguments.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 2.8

Write an IF formula for cell D2 that displays 'Yes' if cell B2 is greater than 1000, and 'No' otherwise.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER

FULL MARKS

=IF(B2>1000, "Yes", "No").

Order vs Isolate

Sort: Reorders rows (A–Z alphabetical, or Largest to Smallest numerical). Filter: Temporarily hides rows that do not match criteria (e.g. show ONLY customers in 'Oxford').

SORT (Reorder)

- A to Z (Alphabetical)
- High to Low (Sales)
- Keeps all records visible

FILTER (Isolate)

- Funnel icon on headers
- Hides non-matching rows
- e.g. Show 'London' only

★ **Golden Rule: Filtering hides rows; sorting changes their sequence!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Make sure all data columns are selected before sorting, or columns will become mismatched!**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 2.9

What spreadsheet tool would you use to view only employees who work in the 'Finance' department?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

The Filter tool (filtering the Department column by 'Finance').

Titles, Axes & Legends

To score full marks on spreadsheet charts: 1. Select category labels AND numerical data together. 2. Choose appropriate chart type (Bar for categories, Line for trends). 3. Add Chart Title, Axis Titles, and Legend.

CHART LABELLING CHECKLIST

- [✓] Meaningful Chart Title at top
- [✓] Horizontal Axis Title (e.g. Month / Department)
- [✓] Vertical Axis Title (e.g. Revenue (£) / Patient Count)

★ **Golden Rule: Every chart must have a clear descriptive Title and labelled X and Y axes!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't include the 'Total' row when highlighting data for a pie chart — it distorts the slices.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 2.10

Which chart type is best for showing sales figures over 12 consecutive months?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

A line chart (ideal for showing continuous trends over time).

The 6 × 6 Rule & Slide Masters

Best practice: 6 × 6 Rule: Maximum 6 bullet points per slide, with 6 words per bullet. Use consistent Slide Master layouts, high-contrast fonts (dark on light), and avoid distracting animations.

SLIDE PRESENTATION RULES

- 6 × 6 Rule: Avoid dense walls of text
- High-contrast colours for legibility
- Consistent corporate theme across all slides

★ **Golden Rule: Slides are visual prompts for the speaker, not essays to read aloud!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Don't use low-contrast text (e.g. yellow font on white background).**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 2.11

State two design principles that make a presentation slide easy for an audience to read.

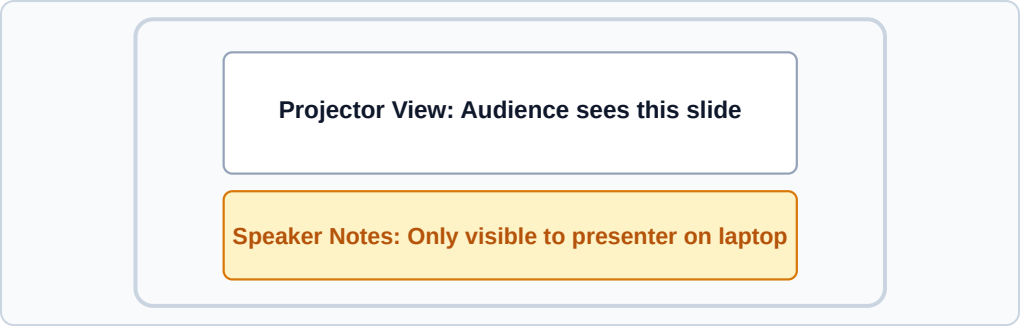
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

1. Using bullet points instead of dense paragraphs. 2. Maintaining high contrast between text and background.

Visible to Speaker Only

Speaker Notes Pane: Area underneath each slide where the presenter writes their talking script. In 'Presenter View', notes are visible on the speaker's laptop screen while the audience only sees the slides.



★ **Golden Rule: Put detailed speech text in the Speaker Notes, NOT on the slide itself!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Make sure your display is set to 'Extend' rather than 'Duplicate' to use Presenter View.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 2.12

Where should a presenter put detailed talking points that they do not want the audience to see on the main screen?

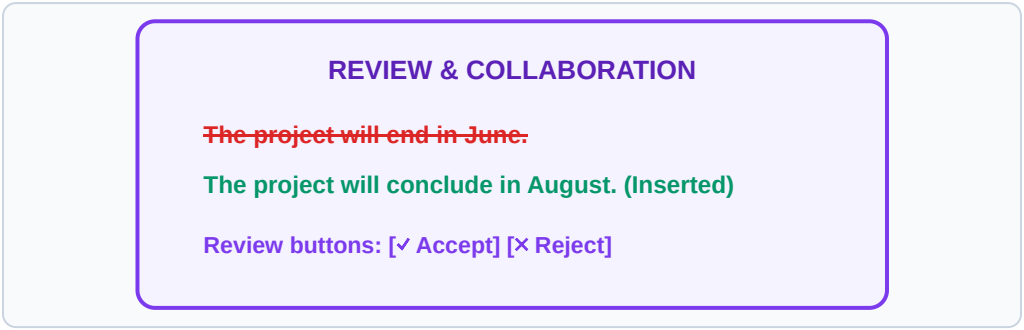
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

In the Speaker Notes pane (using Presenter View).

Comments & Suggesting Edits

Track Changes records every edit (strikethroughs, insertions in coloured ink). Other reviewers can: 1. Add Comments to discuss points. 2. 'Accept' or 'Reject' individual changes before finalizing.



★ **Golden Rule: Always accept or reject all tracked changes before sending documents to clients!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Leaving tracked changes active can leak internal confidential comments.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 2.13

What tool allows multiple team members to review a Word document and propose text edits without overwriting the original text?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Track Changes.

File → Export → Create PDF

Why export to PDF: 1. Universal compatibility (opens on any phone/PC without needing Word). 2. Preserves exact layout, fonts, and images. 3. Prevents accidental editing. 4. Smaller file size.

WHY CONVERT TO PDF?

- ✓ Formatting is locked and preserved
- ✓ Opens on any device without Microsoft Office
- ✓ Ideal format for invoices, certificates & CVs

★ **Golden Rule: Save as PDF to lock your formatting before printing or emailing!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Always keep your original .docx or .xlsx master file in case you need to edit later.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DFS 2.14

Give two reasons why job applications require CVs to be submitted as PDF files.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

1. Formatting, fonts, and layout remain fixed across all devices. 2. The recipient cannot easily edit or corrupt the text.

Clear, Actionable Email Hierarchy

A professional email includes: 1. A clear, specific subject line. 2. A polite formal salutation. 3. Concise body paragraphs stating the main purpose. 4. An unambiguous call-to-action or deadline. 5. A professional sign-off and signature block.

PROFESSIONAL EMAIL STRUCTURE

Subject: Project Update: Q3 Budget Review - 14 Oct

Dear Ms Higgins, / Hi Team,

Please find attached the updated figures for your review.

Action: Kindly confirm sign-off by 5pm this Thursday.

Kind regards, | Alex Patel (Senior Analyst)

★ **Golden Rule: Always write a descriptive subject line before composing the email body!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Avoid vague or blank subject lines like 'urgent' or 'hi' which trigger spam filters.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DFS 3.1

Why is 'Q3 Budget Review - Approval Needed by Thursday' far more effective than just 'Budget' as an email subject line?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

It specifies the exact topic, the action required (approval), and the deadline, allowing the recipient to prioritize immediately.

Direct Action vs Courtesy vs Privacy

To: Direct recipients expected to read and take action. Cc (Carbon Copy): People kept informed for visibility; no direct action expected. Bcc (Blind Carbon Copy): Hidden recipients; preserves privacy and complies with UK GDPR when emailing groups.



★ **Golden Rule: Use Bcc for group emails to keep recipient email addresses private!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Putting client emails in 'To' or 'Cc' is a direct GDPR violation.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DFS 3.2

A community organiser is emailing 120 residents about a neighbourhood meeting. Should they use To, Cc, or Bcc?

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Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

Bcc (Blind Carbon Copy), to prevent exposing residents' private email addresses to one another in violation of UK GDPR.

Direct File vs Cloud Share Link

Email Attachments: Suitable for small individual files under 15-20 MB. Cloud Links (OneDrive, Google Drive): Best for large files, videos, or collaborative live editing. Cloud links prevent mailbox quota exhaustion and allow permission revoking.

DIRECT ATTACHMENT

- File size limit (~20 MB)
- Static snapshot copy
- Cannot revoke access

Best for: Final invoices, receipts

CLOUD SHARE LINK

- Unlimited file size
- Real-time live collaboration
- Permissions can be revoked

Best for: Large decks, team docs

★ **Golden Rule: Use cloud links instead of heavy attachments to avoid bouncing emails!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Check sharing permissions before sending a cloud link so recipients can actually open it.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 3.3

Why might an email containing a 65 MB video attachment fail to reach the recipient?

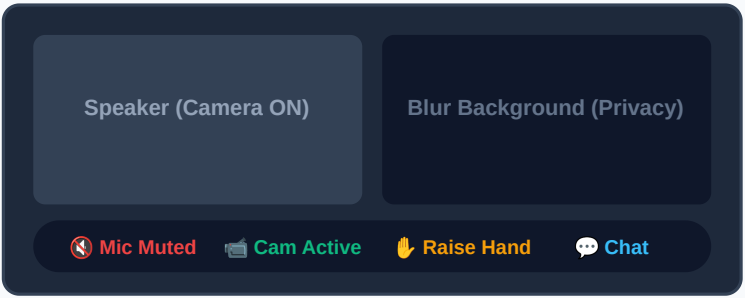
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Most email providers enforce attachment size limits between 20 MB and 25 MB, causing larger files to be rejected.

Mute, Backgrounds & Participation

Key video meeting protocols: 1. Keep microphone MUTED when not speaking to eliminate background noise. 2. Enable Background Blur or a neutral virtual background for privacy. 3. Use 'Raise Hand' feature to speak without interrupting. 4. Maintain eye contact near camera.



★ **Golden Rule: Mute your microphone when not speaking to eliminate background noise!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Place light in FRONT of you — backlighting turns you into a shadow.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 3.4

What two features in Microsoft Teams help protect your home privacy and prevent talking over colleagues?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Background Blur (protects privacy) and the 'Raise Hand' button (prevents speaking over others).

Channels vs Direct Messages (DMs)

Organise chat communication efficiently: 1. Use Channels for team-wide project topics and public discussions. 2. Use Direct Messages (DMs) for private, 1-to-1 conversations. 3. Use thread replies to keep specific conversations clustered. 4. Use @mentions sparingly.



★ **Golden Rule: Use @mentions only when an immediate action or response is required!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Avoid @everyone for routine updates — it creates notification fatigue.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 3.5

When should you discuss a work issue in a public project channel rather than sending a private direct message?

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✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

When the information, decision, or answer is relevant to the entire team and should be searchable in future.

Creating Invites, Times & Agendas

To schedule effective meetings: 1. Add clear Title and meeting purpose. 2. Specify Date, Start time, and Duration. 3. Include meeting link (Teams/Meet) or physical room. 4. Use Scheduling Assistant to check attendees' free/busy availability. 5. Include an agenda.



★ **Golden Rule: Always include the video link and agenda in the calendar description!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Check colleague availability and working hours before sending invites.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 3.6

What calendar feature lets you view whether your colleagues are in other meetings before scheduling an appointment?

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✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

The Scheduling Assistant (or 'Find a Time' view).

Written Nuance in Online Spaces

Digital messages lack body language and vocal inflections. Follow core netiquette: 1. NEVER WRITE IN ALL CAPS (read as shouting). 2. Avoid ambiguous sarcasm or irony. 3. Be polite, constructive, and concise. 4. Proofread messages before hitting send.



★ **Golden Rule: Re-read your message through the recipient's eyes before clicking send!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Words typed in CAPITAL LETTERS are universally understood online as shouting.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 3.7

Why is typing workplace communications in capital letters considered unacceptable digital practice?

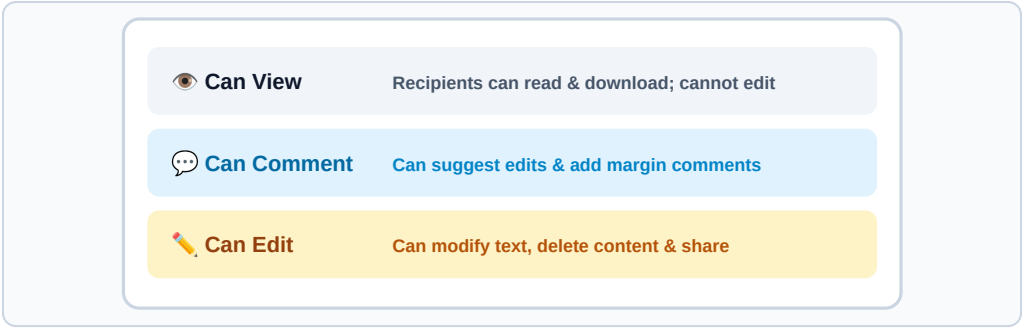
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Typing in all capital letters is universally perceived as shouting, aggressive, or hostile.

Viewer vs Commenter vs Editor Roles

Protect cloud files by assigning the minimum required permissions: 1. Can View (Read-Only; cannot modify or delete content). 2. Can Comment (can read and leave margin feedback notes without altering text). 3. Can Edit (Full read/write permissions). Restrict links to specific people.



★ Golden Rule: Set permissions to 'Can View' unless collaborative editing is needed!

⚠️ Watch Out: Never set links to 'Anyone with the link can edit' for company files.

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 3.8

Which sharing permission should you give a client to let them review a proposal and suggest changes without risking text deletion?

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✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

'Can Comment' (Commenter permission).

HTTPS, SSL Encryption & Merchant Checks

Safe online shopping requirements: 1. Confirm the address begins with 'https://' with a padlock icon (data encrypted in transit). 2. Inspect domain spelling carefully to avoid fake clones. 3. Check independent reviews on Trustpilot. 4. Ensure clear contact details and postal address exist.



★ **Golden Rule: Look for 'https://' and the padlock icon before entering card data!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Avoid online shopping on public, open Wi-Fi networks without a VPN.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DFS 4.1

What does the 's' in 'https://' indicate about the communication between your browser and the website?

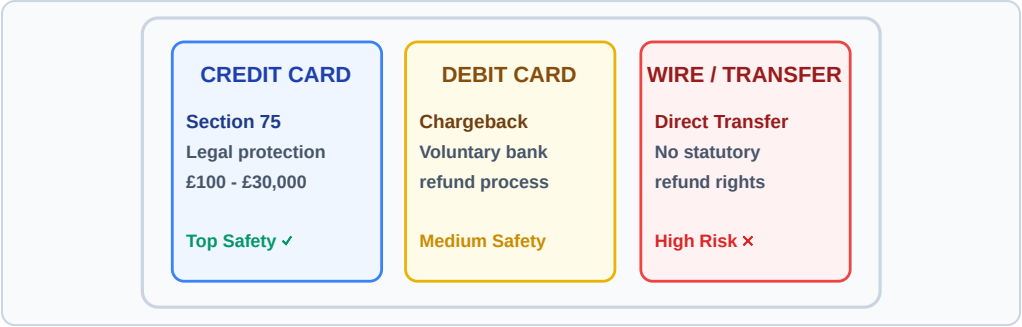
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

It stands for 'Secure' (SSL/TLS encryption), meaning data transferred between your browser and the site is encrypted.

Credit vs Debit vs Digital Wallets

Payment safeguards: 1. Credit Cards: UK Section 75 Consumer Credit Act legally protects single purchases over £100 up to £30,000 if goods fail to arrive or seller collapses. 2. Debit Cards: Protected by voluntary Chargeback scheme. 3. Digital Wallets (Apple Pay/PayPal): Tokenises card details.



★ **Golden Rule: Use a credit card for £100+ purchases for Section 75 legal refund cover!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Direct bank transfers offer almost no buyer protection if scammed.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 4.2

Why is paying with a credit card safer than paying via direct bank transfer when purchasing a £400 laptop online?

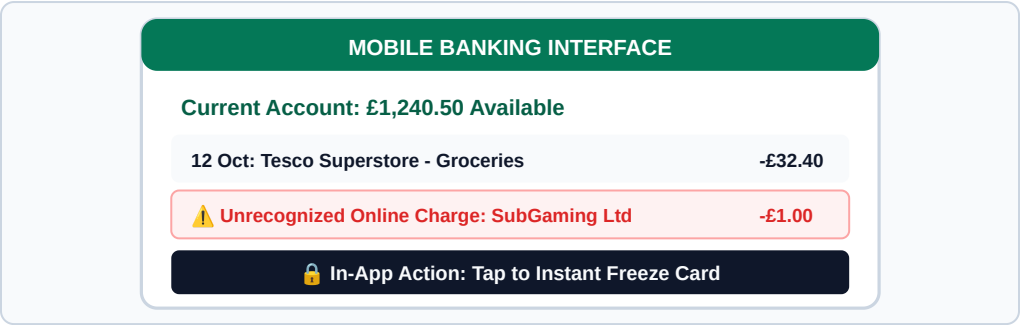
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Under Section 75 of the Consumer Credit Act, the credit card provider is jointly liable with the retailer if goods are faulty or never delivered.

Reconciling Transactions & Card Freezes

Banking safely online: 1. Regularly review transaction history to spot unauthorized micro-charges. 2. Verify all active Direct Debits and standing orders. 3. Immediately 'Freeze' lost cards inside mobile banking app. 4. Never access banking on public shared PCs.



★ **Golden Rule: Review online banking weekly to spot unauthorised charges promptly!**

⚠ **Watch Out: Never share one-time passcodes (OTPs) with anyone — banks never ask.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 4.3

What in-app mobile banking tool allows you to immediately block all transactions if you misplace your card?

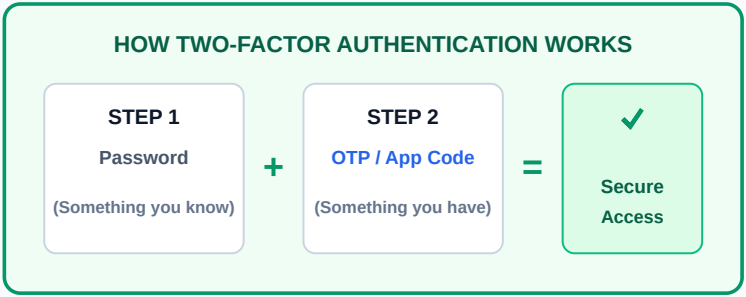
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

The 'Freeze' or 'Lock Card' toggle switch.

Something You Know + Something You Have

2FA adds an essential second security barrier: 1. Factor 1: Password (something you know). 2. Factor 2: One-Time Passcode (OTP) via authenticator app, SMS, or biometric fingerprint (something you have/are). If hackers steal your password, they still cannot gain access.



★ **Golden Rule: Enable 2FA everywhere — authenticator apps are much safer than SMS!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: SMS codes are vulnerable to SIM-swap fraud; prefer app-based 2FA.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 4.4

Why does two-factor authentication (2FA) protect your account even if a cybercriminal steals your password?

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✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Because login is blocked without the second factor (the unique code sent to your physical device or generated by your authenticator app).

GOV.UK, NHS App & Council Portals

Official UK public digital services: 1. GOV.UK: Apply for passports, check tax codes, Universal Credit, and renew driving licences. 2. NHS App: Order repeat prescriptions, view GP records, book blood tests. 3. Local Council: Pay Council Tax, register to vote, apply for parking permits.



★ **Golden Rule: Access public services directly via GOV.UK or NHS.UK official domains!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Beware of copycat websites charging fees for free public services.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 4.5

How can you verify that a website offering driving licence renewals is the legitimate government service?

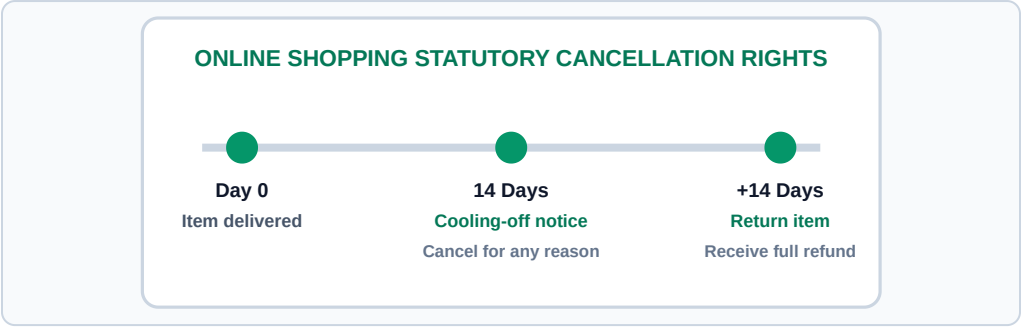
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Check that the URL ends in '.gov.uk' (the official UK government domain).

14-Day Cooling-Off Period & Refunds

UK Consumer Contracts Regulations 2013 give statutory rights for online distance shopping: 1. 14 days from delivery date to cancel an order for any reason. 2. A further 14 days to return the item. 3. Full refund including standard delivery cost. Exemptions: Perishables, custom-made goods, unsealed hygiene items.



★ **Golden Rule: Online orders give a statutory 14-day cooling-off cancellation right!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Perishable and custom-made items are exempt from statutory returns.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DFS 4.6

A customer purchases a pair of standard trainers online. How many days do they legally have after delivery to cancel the purchase?

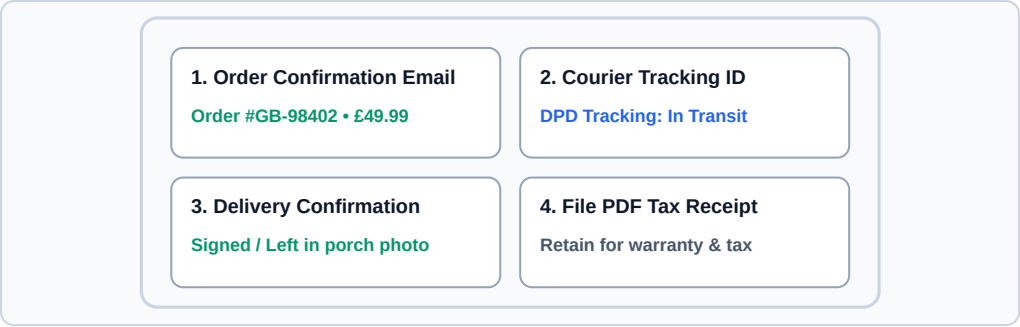
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

14 calendar days from the day of delivery under the Consumer Contracts Regulations.

Saving Proof of Purchase & Tracking

Keep accurate records for online transactions: 1. Save confirmation emails and PDF receipts in a dedicated 'Purchases' email folder. 2. Record the Order ID, vendor name, and date. 3. Use parcel tracking numbers to track courier delivery progress. 4. Inspect goods promptly on arrival.



★ **Golden Rule: Save order confirmations into a dedicated receipts folder or cloud PDF!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Retailers can close accounts — always save an offline copy of receipts.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE
DFS 4.7

What key piece of information in an order confirmation email is required when contacting customer support about a missing parcel?

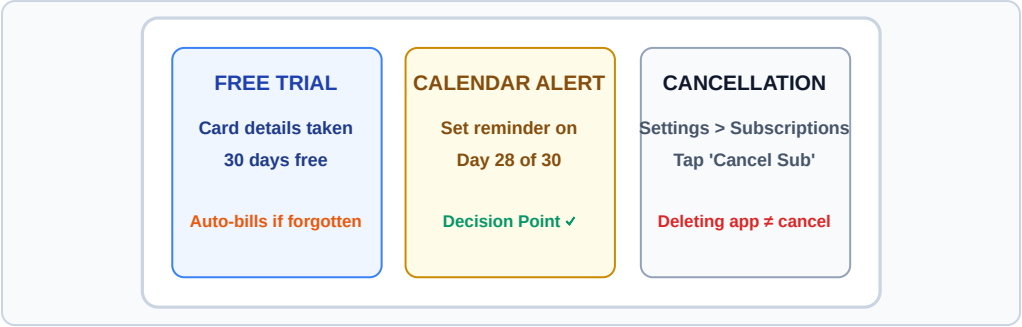
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations
Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER
FULL MARKS

The Order Reference Number (Order ID).

Free Trial Traps & Direct Debit Guarantee

Managing online subscriptions: 1. 'Free trials' automatically roll into paid monthly recurring subscriptions unless cancelled prior to renewal. 2. Set a calendar alert 2 days before the trial finishes. 3. Manage subscriptions via Apple App Store / Google Play subscriptions. 4. Direct Debit Guarantee covers unnotified debits.



★ **Golden Rule: Set a calendar alert to review or cancel free trials before renewal!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Deleting an app does NOT cancel an active recurring paid subscription.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 4.8

If you delete a paid fitness application from your smartphone, will your recurring monthly payments stop automatically?

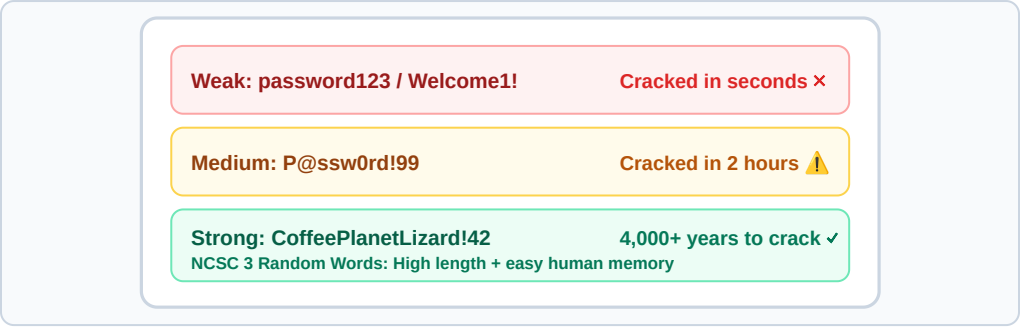
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

No. You must explicitly cancel the subscription inside your device's App Store / Google Play account settings or provider website.

Length Trumps Complexity: Three Random Words

UK NCSC recommendation: Use 'Three Random Words' to build long, uncrackable passphrases that are easy to remember (e.g. 'CoffeePlanetLizard!'). Minimum 12-16 characters. Combine uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and symbols. NEVER reuse passwords across accounts.



★ **Golden Rule: Combine three random words into a 14+ character secure passphrase!**

⚠ **Watch Out: Never reuse your primary email password on any other website.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 5.1

Why is 'RocketTeapotBlanket!' a stronger password than 'P@ssw0rd1' despite being easier to remember?

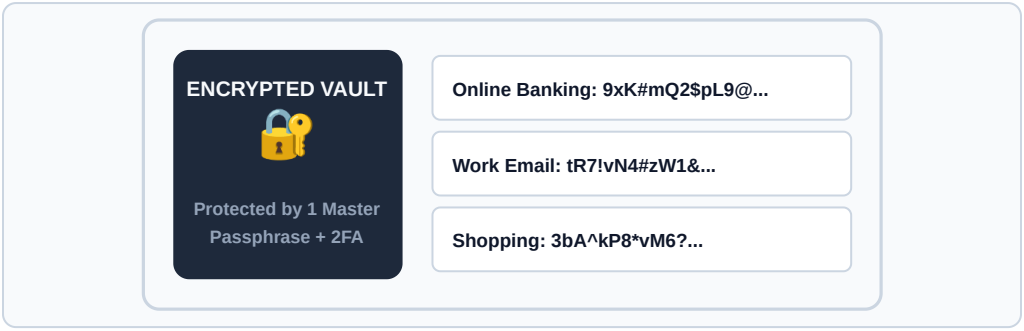
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Because length is the primary defence against brute-force attacks; 19 characters takes centuries to crack, while 9 characters takes minutes.

Encrypted Vaults & Unique Logins

Password managers (Bitwarden, 1Password, Apple Keychain) store all your passwords inside a military-grade encrypted digital vault. Benefits: 1. You only need to remember ONE strong Master Password. 2. Auto-generates random 20-character passwords. 3. Autofills logins on trusted sites.



★ **Golden Rule: Use a password manager so every account has a unique, strong password!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Never write passwords on sticky notes or keep them in unencrypted files.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 5.2

What is the primary security advantage of using a password manager over using the same password for 10 different websites?

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✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

If one website suffers a security breach, your other accounts remain completely secure because each site has a unique password.

Urgency, Sender Spoofing & Malicious Links

Spotting fraudulent messages: 1. Artificial urgency ('Account suspended in 24 hrs!'). 2. Fake sender email domain (e.g. service@hmrc-tax-refunds.com instead of gov.uk). 3. Generic salutations ('Dear Customer'). 4. Suspicious links (hover cursor to view true destination URL).

ANATOMY OF A PHISHING ATTACK

- 🚩 **Fake Sender: security@paypal-verification-uk.com (Not paypal.com!)**
- 🚩 **Panic & Threat: "Your account will be suspended within 2 hours!"**
- 🚩 **Deceptive Link: Display says "Login" but points to "scam-site.ru"**

Hover over links to inspect real destination address

Forward suspicious emails to: report@phishing.gov.uk

★ **Golden Rule: Hover over links to verify the actual destination URL before clicking!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: HMRC and banks never text or email links asking for security details.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE

DFS 5.3

What should you do before clicking on a link in an unexpected email claiming your account has been compromised?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations

Formula Working Area

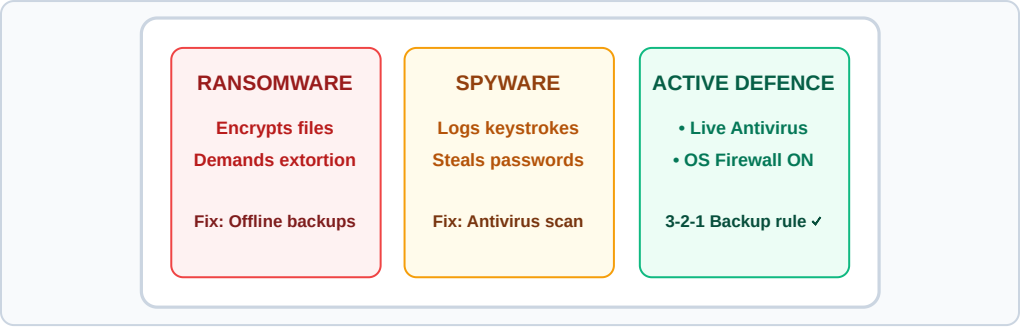
✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER

FULL MARKS

Hover your mouse over the link to verify the true destination URL, or visit the official website directly via your browser.

Malicious Software Types & Defence

Key malware categories: 1. Virus/Trojan: Malicious code hidden inside innocent-looking files. 2. Spyware/Keylogger: Silently records passwords and browsing habits. 3. Ransomware: Encrypts your files and demands money for decryption. Defence: Active antivirus and regular offline backups.



★ **Golden Rule: Maintain offline backups of critical data to safeguard from ransomware!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Never enable macros on unexpected email attachments from strangers.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 5.4

What is ransomware, and what proactive step best ensures you never have to pay a ransom to recover files?

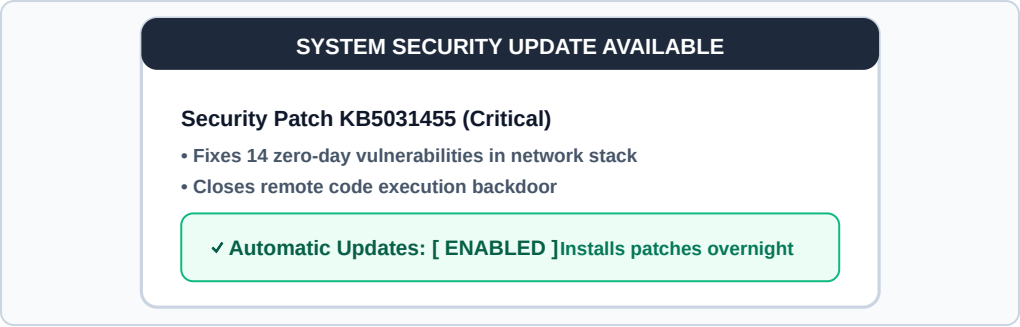
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Ransomware is malicious software that encrypts your files and demands payment. Maintaining regular offline backups ensures you can restore files without paying.

Zero-Day Flaws & Automatic Updates

Software and operating system updates provide critical security patches that close vulnerabilities before cybercriminals exploit them. Always enable automatic updates for: Windows/macOS, smartphones (iOS/Android), web browsers (Chrome/Edge), and antivirus software.



★ **Golden Rule: Enable automatic updates so operating systems and apps patch flaws fast!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Postponing security updates leaves systems vulnerable to known exploits.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 5.5

Why is installing operating system updates vital even if you do not care about new visual features?

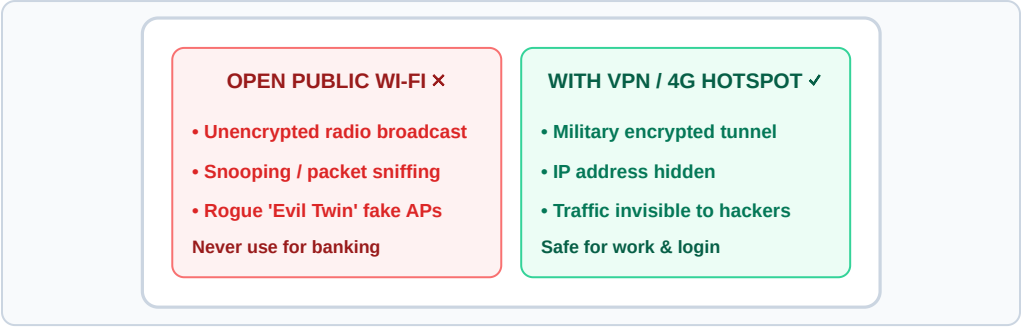
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

Because updates contain security patches that fix discovered vulnerabilities, preventing hackers and malware from exploiting them.

Unencrypted Networks & Encrypted Tunnels

Public Wi-Fi in cafes, hotels, and airports carries risks: 1. Man-in-the-Middle attacks (eavesdropping unencrypted packets). 2. Fake rogue hotspots ('Evil Twins'). Safety rules: Avoid banking on public Wi-Fi; use mobile 4G/5G tethering; use a reputable Virtual Private Network (VPN).



★ **Golden Rule: Use mobile data hotspot or a VPN when connecting on public Wi-Fi!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Rogue open Wi-Fi hotspots can intercept unencrypted network passwords.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 5.6

What does a Virtual Private Network (VPN) do to protect your data when using public Wi-Fi?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

It creates an encrypted tunnel between your device and the internet, preventing anyone on the public network from viewing your data.

Auditing Visibility, Location Tags & Permissions

Safeguarding social media profiles: 1. Set account visibility to 'Private' or 'Friends Only' (never Public). 2. Disable location tagging on posts and photos. 3. Audit third-party apps connected to your profile. 4. Never post identifying details (birth year, mother's maiden name, holiday dates).

SOCIAL PRIVACY AUDIT CHECKLIST

- ✓ Account Privacy: Set to 'Friends Only' (Hidden from public search)
- ✓ Location Services: Geotagging turned OFF on photos
- ✓ Connected Apps: Revoked permissions for unused quizzes & games
- ✓ Sensitive Data: Full birth date, phone & home address hidden

★ **Golden Rule: Keep profiles private and avoid posting live location updates when away!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Never post photos of boarding passes — barcodes contain sensitive data.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 5.7

Why is announcing on public social media that your family is departing for a 2-week holiday a significant security risk?

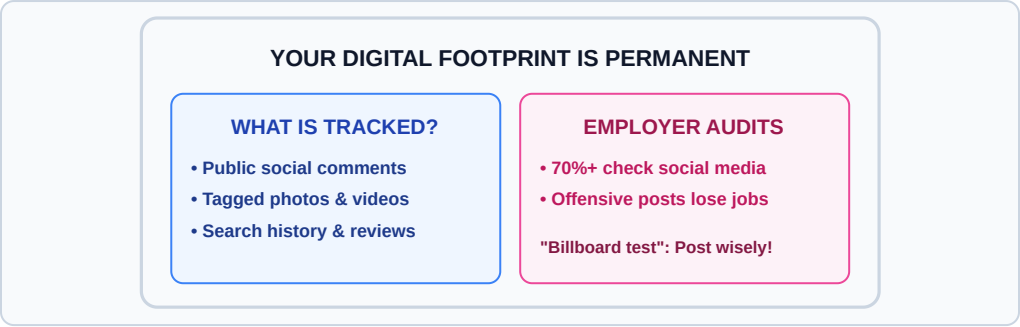
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

It alerts potential burglars that your home will be unoccupied during that exact timeframe.

Permanent Traces & Employer Background Checks

Your digital footprint is the permanent trail of data left by your online activities: comments, posts, tagged photos, forum reviews. Facts: 1. Deleted posts can be archived or screenshotted. 2. 70%+ of UK employers check applicants' public online profiles. 3. Follow the 'billboard test'.



★ **Golden Rule: Only post content you would be comfortable showing to an employer!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Deleting a post does not remove cached versions or viewer screenshots.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 5.8

What is a 'digital footprint', and how can it impact a person's career prospects?

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✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER FULL MARKS

It is the permanent trail of online activity; employers routinely research candidates online, and inappropriate posts can result in rejected applications.

The 20-20-20 Rule, Posture & Screen Limits

Health habits for computer users: 1. 20-20-20 Rule: Every 20 minutes, look at an object 20 feet away for 20 seconds to prevent digital eye strain. 2. Ergonomics: Top of screen at eye level, 90° elbow angle, feet flat. 3. Night light / Blue light filter to safeguard sleep cycles.



★ **Golden Rule: Follow the 20-20-20 rule to prevent digital eye strain during desk work!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Blue light in bed disrupts natural melatonin and degrades sleep quality.**

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 5.9

What does the 20-20-20 rule recommend to help prevent screen-related eye strain?

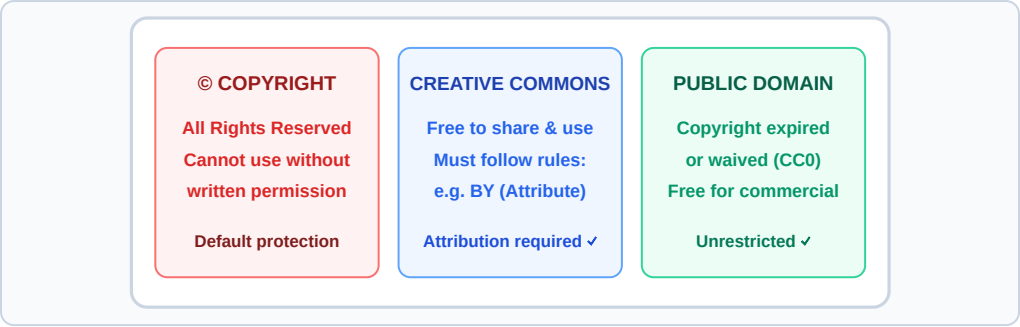
✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

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Every 20 minutes, take a 20-second break to look at an object at least 20 feet away.

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🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE DFS 5.10

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